

CANTON DEV FUND STRATEGY

# DPM Debug: Grant Proposal Strategy

Analysis of approved Canton Dev Fund proposals and a strategy for Lazer's first grant submission, a visual debugging plugin for Daml.

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1,000,000 CC over 16 weeks

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## PART 1: APPROVED PROPOSALS

# What the Foundation Has Funded

Eight approved PRs from the Canton Dev Fund, analyzed at \$0.15 per CC.

| PR   | PROPOSAL                  | PROPOSER         | CC AMOUNT    | USD VALUE    | TIMELINE  |
|------|---------------------------|------------------|--------------|--------------|-----------|
| #159 | CCTools Community Toolkit | 0xScoutr         | 500,000      | \$75,000     | 5 months  |
| #130 | Daml Package Analyzer     | Certora          | 2,010,000    | \$301,500    | 5 months  |
| #53  | ISS-Based BFT Ordering    | Digital Asset    | Undisclosed  | Est. \$500K+ | 8 months  |
| #49  | Daml OS Maintenance       | Digital Asset    | 1,000,000/mo | \$150,000/mo | Recurring |
| #48  | Canton OS Maintenance     | Digital Asset    | 2,000,000/mo | \$300,000/mo | Recurring |
| #47  | Splice OS Maintenance     | Digital Asset    | 1,000,000/mo | \$150,000/mo | Recurring |
| #32  | Daml3 Training Program    | Obsidian Systems | 5,290,000    | \$740,600    | 34 weeks  |
| #24  | Multi-VM Canton (EVM)     | Zenith           | 2,000,000/mo | \$300,000/mo | 12 months |

# How They Structured Milestones

CC

## CCTools (#159)

3 milestones, front-loaded: 200K CC (40%) in M1 for core learn-to-earn platform. 175K for infra and DeFi dashboard. 125K for API and mobile PWA.



## Certora (#130)

4 milestones, back-loaded: 335K CC each for M1 and M2 (build + initial adoption). 670K each for M3 and M4 (tied to 5+ production deployments each).



## Obsidian (#32)

4 milestones over 34 weeks. 5,290,000 CC total (revised down 20% from original \$927K ask). Modules, certification exams, and 12 coding videos.



## DA Maintenance

PRs #47, #48, #49: rolling monthly milestones. 1M to 2M CC/mo for ongoing repo maintenance. Acceptance: response times, release cadence, PR reviews.

# What Gets Approved and Why

**STRUCTURE**  
**3 to 5 Milestones**

Fixed-scope projects use 3 to 5 milestones with explicit, testable acceptance criteria. Not vague deliverables, but conditions like "5 production deployments" or "API accessible with validator tier active."

**FRAMING**  
**Public Good Infra**

Every approved proposal is framed as public-good infrastructure or core protocol work. Dapps and use-case demos are borderline. Open-source licensing (MIT or Apache 2.0) is table stakes.

**CHAMPIONS**  
**Named Sponsor**

Every proposal has a champion from the Foundation or committee. Jatin Pandya offered to champion ours and review drafts before submission.

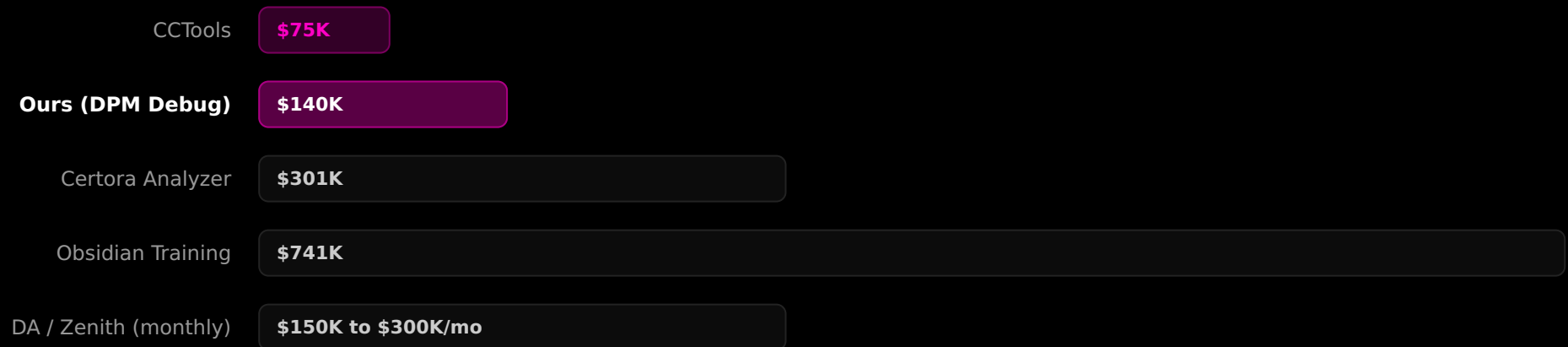
**CREDIBILITY**  
**Prove It First**

CCTools had 20K users before applying. Obsidian voluntarily cut scope by 20%. The strongest proposals show cost discipline and traction, not just ambition.

## PART 2: PATTERNS

# Grant Budget Landscape

Where our \$140K ask sits relative to approved proposals.



- **\$140K is modest and credible** for a first proposal. Above the floor, well below specialized tooling asks. 80% unlocked in the first two milestones.

# Why a Debugger, Why Now

*"A really, really good debugging experience is what lacks on top of Canton. If you ask me personally what I would love to see in the ecosystem, I would say a really good debugging experience."*

**Jatin Pandya, Canton Foundation**

Call with Lazer, April 14, 2026

- **Foundation DX survey** flagged "visual debugging" and "transaction visibility" as top missing tools
- **Jatin offered to champion** our proposal and review drafts before submission

## NO OVERLAP WITH EXISTING PROPOSALS

### **Certora = Compile-Time Static Analysis**

Security auditing of .dar files. Finds potential issues before deployment.

### **Ours = Runtime Dev Debugging**

Visual transaction trees, structured test output, debug logs. Helps developers during active development.

### **DA Maintenance = Keeps DPM Working**

We extend DPM with a plugin. Adds capability, doesn't duplicate effort.

### **Obsidian = Training Content**

Educational modules. Our tooling makes learning-by-doing faster.

# Proposed Grant Structure

16 weeks, 3 milestones. 80% unlocked in M1 and M2.

DURATION

16 weeks

GRANT ASK

1,000,000 CC  
(~\$140K)

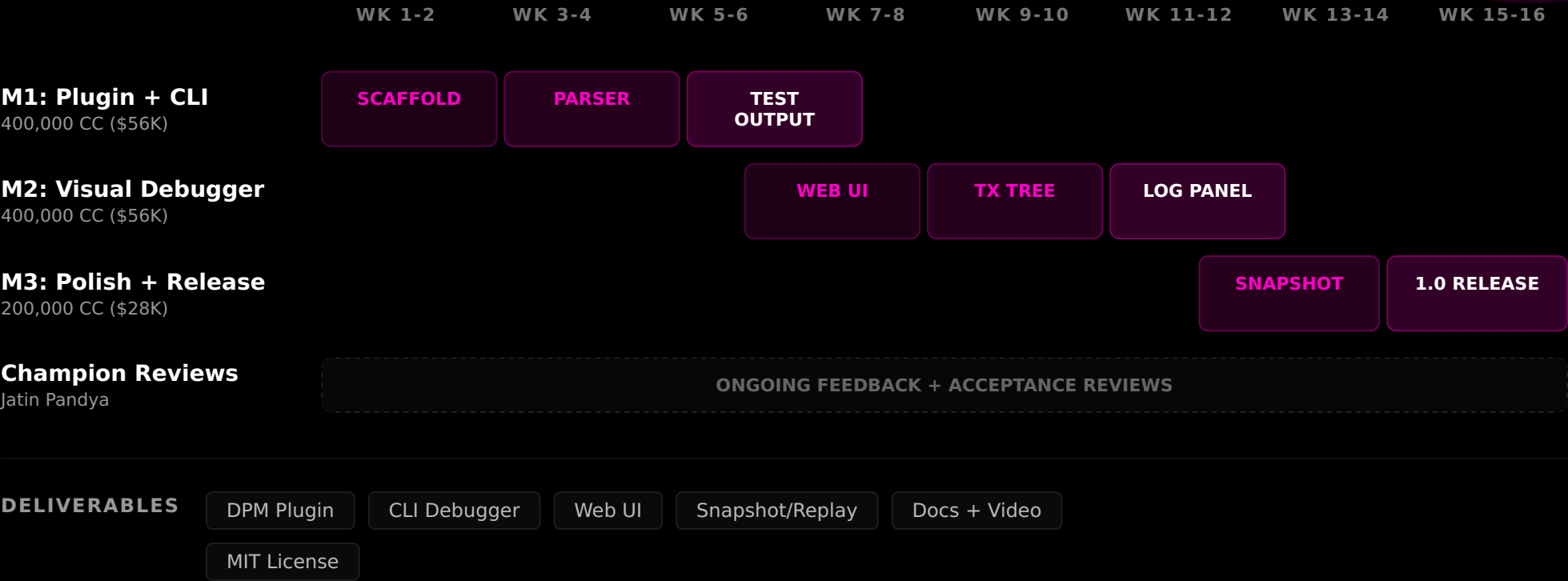
PAYOUT

Milestone-based in CC

| MILESTONE | FOCUS                                                                            | DURATION | CC        | USD       |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|-----------|-----------|
| M1        | DPM plugin scaffold, structured CLI test output, assertion diffs, source linking | 6 weeks  | 400,000   | \$56,000  |
| M2        | Visual transaction tree (web UI), debug/trace log panel, filter and search       | 6 weeks  | 400,000   | \$56,000  |
| M3        | Snapshot/replay, end-to-end docs, walkthrough video, 1.0 release                 | 4 weeks  | 200,000   | \$28,000  |
| Total     |                                                                                  | 16 weeks | 1,000,000 | \$140,000 |



# 16-Week Delivery Timeline



# Why This Wins



## **Builds on DPM**

Jatin specifically recommended this architecture. Extends the tool the Foundation already funds (PR #49) rather than duplicating infrastructure.



## **#1 Cited Gap**

The Foundation's own DX survey and Jatin's direct feedback both identify visual debugging as the single biggest missing piece in the Daml developer experience.



## **Complementary**

Runtime debugging (ours) complements Certora's compile-time static analysis. Different layer, different users, zero overlap.



## **Credible First Ask**

\$140K (\$8.75K/week over 16 weeks), with 80% unlocked in M1 and M2. Positions Lazer for larger follow-up proposals after we deliver.